

# Pozole Rojo

Chile-forward · pork-rich · collagen-extracted · no shortcuts

|           |               |                 |               |
|-----------|---------------|-----------------|---------------|
| YIELD     | TIME          | WATER           | CHILE         |
| 4 L · 6–8 | 1.25 / 3.5 hr | 2 L per kg pork | 200 g per 4 L |

TEMPERATURE TARGETS

paste fries to brick/burgundy; pork done at 195–205°F

|                 |             |                |           |
|-----------------|-------------|----------------|-----------|
| Aromatics broil | 500°F+ char | Chile toast    | 350–375°F |
| Pan browning    | 400–450°F   | Lard for paste | 375–400°F |
| Broth simmer    | 190–200°F   | Pork internal  | 195–205°F |

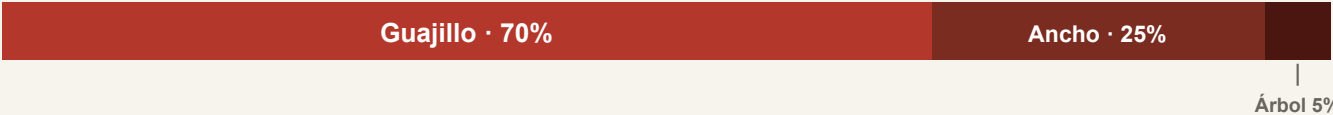
INGREDIENTS

2 L water per kg pork · 50 g chiles per liter

|                          |       |                     |     |         |                                                    |          |
|--------------------------|-------|---------------------|-----|---------|----------------------------------------------------|----------|
| PORK & BROTH             |       | CHILE PASTE — 200 G |     |         | HOMINY & FINISH                                    |          |
| Pork shoulder bone-in    | 2 kg  | Guajillo the red    | 70% | 140 g   | Hominy 2 cans                                      | 1.6 kg   |
| Pig’s feet or 750 g neck | 500 g | Ancho body, sweet   | 25% | 50 g    | Lard total                                         | ~90 g    |
| Water                    | 4 L   | Árbol heat          | 5%  | 10 g    | Apple cider vinegar                                | 15 g     |
| Onions quartered         | 2     | Garlic raw          |     | 25–30 g | Salt                                               | to taste |
| Garlic head halved       | 1     | Cumin · oregano     |     | 3 · 1 g | The spread: cabbage, radish, onion, oregano, lime. |          |
| Bay leaves               | 2     | Salt · peppercorns  |     | 3 g · 6 |                                                    |          |

CHILE RATIO

guajillo carries the red — the dark chiles dull it brown



**Two non-negotiables: collagen + simmer** for body — blanched trotters and a lazy **190–200°F** simmer for 2.5–3 hr are what make the broth rich, not thin (**never a hard boil** — it turns the broth cloudy and greasy). Want more body? Push the trotters to **750 g–1 kg** or add pork skin. And **fry the chile paste to brick/burgundy** in shimmering lard — a clean brick fry cooks out the raw edge and sets the color.

# Build the Pot

## METHOD

broth 2.5–3 hr · start the paste at the 1-hour mark

- 1 **Broil:** onions quartered + garlic halved, cut-side up, 6–8" from the broiler, **8–12 min to char** (500°F+). Reserve 1 onion for the paste.
- 2 **Prep + blanch:** debone the shoulder, cube 2–3", reserve the bone. Scrub the feet, singe any stray hairs, split lengthwise. **Blanch the feet + bone:** cover with cold water, boil **5–10 min**, dump that scummy water, rinse the feet and the pot — this is what keeps the broth clean instead of funky and cloudy.
- 3 **Brown:** shimmering lard, brown the pork in 3–4 batches, 2–3 min/side, to build fond (400–450°F).
- 4 **Simmer:** add bone, collagen cuts, pork, aromatics, bay, water. **Lazy bubbles 2.5–3 hr** at 190–200°F. Skim at 30 min; start the paste at 1 hr.
- 5 **Toast:** dry skillet — árbol 15–20 sec/side, guajillo/ancho/pasilla 30–60 sec/side. Watch for the puff, then stem + seed.
- 6 **Soak:** off-boil hot water, submerge the chiles **25 min**. Reserve the liquid.
- 7 **Blend:** chiles + a cup of the liquid + the roasted onion + raw garlic + spices. **Strain hard**, rinsing with a little broth.
- 8 **Fry:** 4 spoons of lard, shimmering. Add the paste (it sizzles hard), vinegar at 30 sec, stir **3–4 min to brick/burgundy** (375–400°F).
- 9 **Bloom:** kill the heat, stir in the drained hominy, rest **15–20 min** off heat to absorb the chile-lard.
- 10 **Finish:** pork at 195–205°F → remove. Strain + skim the broth, add the chile-hominy, simmer **15 min**, return the pork 5 min. Salt; lime if flat.
- 11 **Serve:** ladle **70% broth, 30% solids**; tear the pork by hand into irregular chunks. Pass the garnishes.

## TROUBLESHOOTING

better on day 2 — the fat cap makes skimming easy

| PROBLEM               | CAUSE                                                             | FIX                                                      |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Thin broth</b>     | No collagen cuts / short simmer                                   | Add feet or neck; simmer 2.5–3 hr min                    |
| <b>Bitter paste</b>   | Burnt or old chiles                                               | Toast less; a pinch of brown sugar if bitter             |
| <b>Brown, not red</b> | Too much dark chile (pasilla / ancho); old or over-toasted chiles | Go guajillo-forward (~70%); glossy chiles, toast lightly |
| <b>Tough pork</b>     | Under 195°F                                                       | Keep simmering — collagen breaks at 195–205°F            |
| <b>Flat flavor</b>    | No acid                                                           | Add lime at the end for brightness                       |